

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T
 ♥ A T 8 3
 ♦ 7 6 5 4 3
 ♣ A 9 6

22
 8 4
 6

♠ A K Q 9 8 3

♥ 2

♦ A K

♣ K Q J 8

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ 7 5 3

♠ 6 5

♥ J 9 7 6

♦ Q J T 9

♣ T 4 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 1

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but

when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by North			

Deal 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 9 7 5

♥ 3

♦ 8 7 5 2

♣ 9 8 5

	23	
5		4
	8	

♠ A 6 4

♥ K J 9

♦ A K Q J 9

♣ K Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 3

♥ A Q T 8 6

♦ T 3

♣ J T 7 4

♠ T 8 2

♥ 7 5 4 2

♦ 6 4

♣ A 6 3 2

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

6♥ by South

North

2♣

4NT

6♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

2♥

5♦

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 2

SOUTH makes a positive 3

♥

response to NORTH's 2♣ opener.

This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

NORTH only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the SOUTH hand.

A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6

♥

.

Deal 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 6 5 4
 ♥ A 9 8 5
 ♦ T 7 5
 ♣ T 8

16
 4 2
 18

♠ A 9 7
 ♥ Q J 4 2
 ♦ K Q 8 6
 ♣ A 5



♠ K Q
 ♥ K 6
 ♦ A 4
 ♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2

♠ J 8 3 2
 ♥ T 7 3
 ♦ J 9 3 2
 ♣ 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 3

When NORTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells SOUTH that 6NT can surely be made.

NORTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But SOUTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

SOUTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and NORTH admits to just two Aces.

So SOUTH settles for the small slam.

Deal 4

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ T 7
♥ Q T 2
♦ J 6 5 2
♣ J 6 4 3

12
4 2
22

♠ J 9 5 2
♥ A J 7 4 3
♦ A Q
♣ 9 8



♠ A K Q 6 4 3
♥ K 5
♦ K 7 3
♣ A K

♠ 8
♥ 9 8 6
♦ T 9 8 4
♣ Q T 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 4

SOUTH has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When NORTH

supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that NORTH has two Aces.

She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that

NORTH will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

Deal 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6
 ♥ 7 2
 ♦ 5 4
 ♣ A 9 4 3 2

8
 6 4
 22

♠ J 7 3
 ♥ A J T 9 8
 ♦ 8 3 2
 ♣ Q 8



♠ A K 2
 ♥ K Q 6 5
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ K J 6

♠ T 5 4
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ A T 9 7 6
 ♣ T 7 5

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 5

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6



when she hears NORTH's positive

response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♥
All Pass			
5 ♥ by North			

Deal 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 5 2

♥ J 9 4 2

♦ 6

♣ J T 6 2

18

3 6

13

♠ K Q 4

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J T 7 3

♣ K 5



♠ A 6 3

♥ K T 7

♦ A 9 4

♣ Q 9 8 7

♠ T 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ A 4 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 6

NORTH not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners.

So when SOUTH jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, NORTH uses Gerber.

SOUTH shows two Aces so NORTH decides 6NT will be just right.

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Deal 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 7 2
 ♥ T 9 7 2
 ♦ K T 9 5 3
 ♣ 7

19
 3 5
 13

♠ A J 9 6 3

♥ A 4

♦ A Q J 6

♣ K 5



♠ K Q 8 5

♥ J 6 3

♦ 8 7

♣ A Q J 4

♠ 4
 ♥ K Q 8 5
 ♦ 4 2
 ♣ T 9 8 6 3 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 7

When SOUTH gives immediate ♠ support,
NORTH's thoughts naturally

turn to slam. This is a good hand to use
Blackwood on, so NORTH bids 4NT.

SOUTH's 5

♦

answer shows one Ace, which NORTH
cleverly deduces

must be the ♣A.

NORTH bids 6♠ since SOUTH has not bid
strongly enough to think about 7.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

Deal 8

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ 6
♦ A 6 5 4
♣ T 9 8 6 5 4

23
4 5
8

♠ K Q J
♥ A K T
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ -

♠ T 9 8 7 3
♥ 5 3 2
♦ T 7
♣ A J 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

NORTH bids 6

♥

, knowing they must lose the

♦

A.

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 8

NORTH expects to bid 2NT at his second turn,
but SOUTH gives a positive 2

♥

response and his thinking changes! First he
supports

♥

s, setting the

trump suit.

SOUTH then bids 3♠, showing first round
control. NORTH tries 4NT (Blackwood) and

SOUTH replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and
one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

Deal 9

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 6
♥ 9 4
♦ J T 4
♣ A Q 8 7 4

14
7 8
11

♠ K 5
♥ A K T 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6



♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ -

♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 2
♦ Q 5 2
♣ K T 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 9

SOUTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card



support,

at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

NORTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

SOUTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

NORTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7



Deal 10

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 6 2
♥ 8 4 2
♦ Q J 5 3
♣ A 4

8
7 7
18

♠ -
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ K 9 8 6 4
♣ J 9 3 2



♠ K 5 3
♥ K Q J T 3
♦ A
♣ K Q T 6

♠ A Q J 9 8 4
♥ 6
♦ T 7 2
♣ 8 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 10

SOUTH figures that if NORTH holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

NORTH only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which

is higher-ranking than



s.

SOUTH manages to figure out that NORTH has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Deal 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q
♥ T 6
♦ T 9 4 3 2
♣ A Q T 9 8

17
8 7
8

♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4

♠ J T 2
♥ 9 5 4 3 2
♦ K Q J
♣ 5 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 11

NORTH may have a good hand but SOUTH merely gave a simple raise.

Even if SOUTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠		2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Deal 12

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A T 9 6
♥ A 7
♦ T 9 7 3
♣ T 3 2

10
8 6
16

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ T 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4



♠ -
♥ K Q J 8 6 3
♦ K J 2
♣ A Q 6 5

♠ K J 8 4 2
♥ 5
♦ Q 6 5 4
♣ 9 8 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			

6 ♥ by South

, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 12

SOUTH has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and NORTH shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one

of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that NORTH holds the

♦

A,

he bids 6

♥

Deal 13

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 4 3
♥ Q 8 5 2
♦ 6 5
♣ Q J 9 5

21
5 4
10

♠ K 6 2
♥ A T 9
♦ A K 3
♣ A K 8 4



♠ A 7
♥ K 3
♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2
♣ 7 6

♠ Q J 9 8 5
♥ J 7 6 4
♦ T
♣ T 3 2

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			

slam and bids 7NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 13

SOUTH isn't sure just how much he can make,
but surely 6

♦

isn't

too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and NORTH
shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and NORTH
shows three.

Hmm, SOUTH can now count all thirteen
tricks, so he forgets about the

Deal 14

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 7
♥ A T 8 5 4
♦ J 7 6
♣ 4 2

11
5 4
20

♠ J 8
♥ J 7 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q T 9 6



♠ A K Q
♥ K Q 6
♦ K Q 3
♣ J 8 7 5

♠ 6 5 4 3 2
♥ 9 3
♦ A T 9 4 2
♣ 3

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 14

NORTH has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it

would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Deal 15

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 3 2
♥ 5 4
♦ Q T 7 2
♣ J 9 8 4

15
3 7
15

♠ K 7 5
♥ Q 9 6
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ A Q 7



♠ A Q 6
♥ K 7 3
♦ K 6
♣ K T 6 5 3

♠ J T 9 4
♥ A J T 8 2
♦ J 5 4
♣ 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4NT

All Pass

4NT by North
declines the invitation. If her



Q

were changed to the



As she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 15

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

SOUTH has a 16 points and NORTH has 15, 16 or 17. SOUTH wants to be in 6NT if NORTH has 17,

but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT.

In this case, NORTH has but 15 points and

Deal 16

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 2
♥ T 9 8 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 5
♣ 9 7 3

18
2 4
16

♠ K Q J 4
♥ K 6
♦ K 4
♣ K Q J T 5



♠ A 8 7 6
♥ Q J 7
♦ A J 3
♣ A 8 2

♠ T 9 5 3
♥ A 5 4
♦ T 8 6 2
♣ 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 16

When SOUTH opens 1NT NORTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT.

So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Deal 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 5
♥ 8 7 4
♦ T 8 6
♣ J T 5 3

27
2 4
7

♠ A K
♥ A Q T 9 6
♦ A Q J 3
♣ A K



♠ 9 7 2
♥ K J 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ 7 6 4 2

♠ Q T 6 4 3
♥ 2
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ Q 9 8

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 17

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♥
Pass	7NT	Pass	

7NT by North

Deal 18

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 9 5 4 3
 ♥ Q J 8 7 6 5
 ♦ -
 ♣ 9 4

20
 3 3
 14

♠ K 7
 ♥ K 9
 ♦ A Q J T 4
 ♣ A Q J 7



♠ A 6 2
 ♥ A T 4
 ♦ K 7 5
 ♣ K 8 6 2

♠ Q J 8
 ♥ 3 2
 ♦ 9 8 6 3 2
 ♣ T 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♠
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 18

NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH

wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid

being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

Deal 19

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 9 7
 ♥ Q J T 8 3
 ♦ A 8
 ♣ 7 5 3

14
 7 7
 12

♠ 6
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ K J 9 7 4
 ♣ A Q J 9 2



♠ A K 5
 ♥ 7
 ♦ Q T 6 5 3
 ♣ K T 8 4

♠ Q J 8 4 3 2
 ♥ A 9 6 5 2
 ♦ 2
 ♣ 6

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 19

NORTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are

missing two Aces!

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
All Pass			
5♦ by North			

Deal 20

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 5
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ 9 8 4 2
 ♣ K J T 9 2

12
 4 8
 16

♠ A Q J 7 3

♥ A J 8 6

♦ 5 3

♣ 8 7



♠ K 4

♥ K Q T 9 5

♦ A 7 6

♣ A 5 4

♠ 9 8 6 2
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ K Q J T
 ♣ Q 6 3

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

6♥ by South

North

1♠

3♥

5♥

East

Pass

Pass

Pass

South

2♥

4NT

6♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 20

SOUTH knows NORTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three

of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, NORTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces SOUTH knows there are not enough points for Grand,

so she bids 6

♥

.

Deal 21

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 8
♥ 6
♦ K T 8 7 3 2
♣ 7 3

15
6 3
16

♠ K 5 3
♥ A T 9 5 2
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 4



♠ A 6 2
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 6
♣ K Q J T 9

♠ T 7 4
♥ 8 4 3
♦ Q J 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	7 ♥
All Pass			
7 ♥ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 21

When SOUTH answers Blackwood with one Ace NORTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, SOUTH would bid 6



.

But she knows that if she does so, NORTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, SOUTH figures her ♣ suit will

supply five tricks so she bids 7



Deal 22

South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 3
♥ K 3
♦ 8 7 4 3
♣ 9 5 4 2

11
4 5
20

♠ 8 7
♥ Q 9 7 4
♦ K Q 5
♣ A T 8 3



♠ A K Q 5
♥ A J 6 5 2
♦ 6
♣ K Q J

♠ T 6 4 2
♥ T 8
♦ A J T 9 2
♣ 7 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♥
All Pass			
5 ♥ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 22

SOUTH thinks there might be slam if NORTH holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When NORTH shows just one Ace SOUTH is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so

he stops at 5



.

It turns out that SOUTH might make twelve tricks, depending on the



K situation.

Deal 23

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ 9 6 3
♦ T 9 5 4 3
♣ T 8 5

18
2 4
16

♠ A J 6
♥ K 5
♦ A Q 6 2
♣ A 9 7 4



♠ K 4 2
♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2
♦ K
♣ K 3

♠ T 9 7 5 3
♥ T
♦ J 8 7
♣ Q J 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by North
Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 23

SOUTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam

in



s. He chooses to temporize with a 1



response and is rewarded when NORTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents SOUTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine.

When he discovers that NORTH holds three

Deal 24

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J T 7 2
♥ J 6 5 3 2
♦ 7 6 4
♣ 3

24
2 4
10

♠ A K
♥ K Q 4
♦ K Q J 3
♣ K Q J 5



♠ Q 6 3
♥ A T 7
♦ 9 5 2
♣ A T 8 6

♠ 9 8 5 4
♥ 9 8
♦ A T 8
♣ 9 7 4 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 24

SOUTH responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

NORTH only needs to know how many Aces are in the SOUTH hand. He must use Gerber since

4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows two Aces NORTH bids 6NT.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			